

and expertise to mentor each team to develop and prototype their innovation using hardware platforms provided by Intel. The participants in this contest get to architect, design and develop novel embedded applications in areas such as – Consumer Electronics, Digital Security Surveillance, Medical, Education, Storage and In-Vehicle Infotainment amongst others.

Intel conducted its 4th Intel® India Embedded Challenge in December 2014, where it received 2400 registrations out of which 650 innovative ideas were shortlisted and 40 prototypes were displayed at the Intel® India Innovation Conclave. The Intel® IEC finalists were mentored by over 50 technologists from Intel India.

TECHNO GIRLZ INITIATIVE

Intel also partnered with the Government of India to launch an education initiative on children's day in November 2014, called "Techno Girlz" which aims to encourage young girls towards scientific endeavours by inculcating scientific aptitude, spur creativity and foster the spirit of innovation amongst their young minds. Staying true to the commitment of Digital India, the program entailed conducting 10 winter camps to reach 1000 girls (K4-K9 grades) in 10 cities across the country, enhancing skill development and building intellectual capacity among girls at an early age. In addition to that, an impact study was undertaken to assess the skills learnt and the behavioral changes in the young minds after attending these workshops.

Techno Girlz is targeted to transform the thought process of young students by building awareness about Do It Yourself (DIY) culture through play and learn activities in order to spur creativity and a spirit of invention. The initiative is intended towards fostering scientific temperament by accessing the kids' ingenious bent of mind and encouraging them towards Science, Math, Engineering, and Technology (STEM) studies. Techno Girlz, in association with Government Schools for girls across the country, conducted workshops with the help of the subject experts. The workshops included hands on enrichment sessions that would guide the students to come up with Creative Technology based designs.

EXPANDING REMOTE CONNECTIVITY WITH INTERNET OF THINGS

Internet of Things is the next level of evolution towards developing connected devices. With the help of unique hardware and developer kits along with sensors available from Intel, one



From Left to Right: Professor Rakesh Basant, chairperson, CIIE; Ms. Debjani Ghosh, vice president, Sales and Marketing Group and managing director, Intel South Asia; Shri H K Mittal, Member Secretary, National Science and Technology Entrepreneurship Development Board (NSTEDB); Vikas Jain, co-founder, Micromax Informatics and Shri Gaurav Dwivedi, CEO, MyGov.in

can create smart devices that connect with each other resulting in innovative solutions to tackle challenges like you never imagined before.

This is especially important in the context of the Digital India transformation, where cheap and easy to use technology solutions are needed in order to create intuitive, easy-to-use products that enable and drive access to services imperative for development. Some of these critical services include Financial services, Healthcare, Education and E-governance. The Intel & DST - Innovate for Digital India Challenge too is seeking participation from innovators who can develop products and solutions for such verticals.

Such devices are expected to revolutionise the way people in remote villages and other places connect with technology.

Another Intel® technology called the Intel® Edison platform also comes into the picture in the context of IoT. It is a solution designed to lower the barriers to entry for quick prototyping and productizing the connected computing devices driving the next industrial revolution. Intel® Edison technology was designed specifically for the creators of these devices – emerging entrepreneurs eager to invent the future. It combines a small, powerful, adaptable hardware platform and partner-enabled ecosystem with extended software compatibility and supportive online environment.

Intel is also hosting 20 Intel® IoT Roadshows for maker communities in cities across US, Europe, South America and Asia. This two-day hackathon is open to all including makers, IoT startups, developers, students and hardware novices. Participants will get a free Intel® IoT Developer Kit which will include an Intel® development board. The Dev-kit is based on Intel® Architecture and designed to be hardware and software pin-compatible with Arduino. It is also well-equipped with sensors, software and accessories to stimulate one's creativity. Intel® Software recently concluded its two-day Intel® Internet of Things (IoT) roadshow on 11th and 12th April 2015 in Bengaluru. 153 makers and pro-makers came together at this 24 hour hackathon to build IoT enabled solutions. 45 IoT solutions were created using Intel® IoT Developer kits which includes an Intel® Edison board which is an Arduino-compatible development board featuring Intel® Architecture.

The winner, DriveAlert, created a smart IoT enabled solution to prevent mishaps due to drowsy driving/ flying and enhancing driver efficiency using their driving data. The solution will not only help detect drowsy driving but also improve driver's efficiency by using the captured data. The device will capture behavior patterns of the driver and his interaction with the components of the vehicle. This gathered data will be then used to give the driver a feedback, in turn improving his efficiency. ■